

SOCIAL SERVICES

LECTURE # 01

Social services are the services provided by the government, NGOs (Non-Governmental Organizations), or private welfare organizations to improve the quality of life for people, especially those in need.

Examples of Social Services:

- Education (Schools, Colleges, Vocational Training Centers)
- Healthcare (Hospitals, Clinics, Vaccination Programs)
- Housing (Affordable Housing Schemes for the Poor)
- Financial Assistance (Zakat, BISP, Scholarships)
- Employment Support (Skill Development Programs)
- Legal Aid (Free Legal Help for Poor People)

Note: Most of the topics for the course log were discussed in this lecture.

LECTURE # 02

Society Structure -> Family Structure

Family structures is a fundamental part of studying social services, as families are the basic units of society.

Two types of family structures:

1. Nuclear Family Structure

A nuclear family is a small, self-contained family unit consisting of two parents (mother and father) and their children. This is often considered the "traditional" family structure in many societies.

Characteristics of a Nuclear Family:

- Small in size.
- Independent living (not sharing a household with extended family).
- Focused on the immediate family unit.
- Common in urban or industrialized societies.

Example:

A married couple, John and Mary, live with their two children, Emma and Liam, in their own home. They do not live with grandparents, aunts, uncles, or cousins. This is a typical nuclear family.

2. Non-Nuclear Family Structure

3. A non-nuclear family refers to any family structure that does not fit the nuclear model. These families can take many forms and are often more diverse. Non-nuclear families include:

Types of Non-Nuclear Families:

Single-Parent Family:

One parent (either mother or father) raises the child(ren) alone.

Example: Sarah is a single mother raising her son, Alex, after her divorce.

Extended Family:

Includes relatives beyond the nuclear family, such as grandparents, aunts, uncles, or cousins, living together or closely involved.

Example: Maria lives with her husband, their two children, and her elderly mother in the same household.

Blended Family (Stepfamily):

Formed when two families merge, often after divorce and remarriage.

Example: After remarrying, Tom and his daughter Lily now live with his new wife, Jessica, and her son, Noah.

Childless Family:

A couple without children, either by choice or due to circumstances.

Example: David and Emily are married but have chosen not to have children.

Grandparent Family:

Grandparents raising their grandchildren due to various circumstances (e.g., parents' absence, illness, or inability to care for the children).

Example: Mr. and Mrs. Patel are raising their grandson, Arjun, because his parents are working abroad.

Foster/Adoptive Family:

Families that take in children who are not biologically theirs, either temporarily (foster care) or permanently (adoption).

Example: The Smiths are fostering a teenager, Mia, while her biological family works through some challenges.

Size	Small – consists of parents and their children.	Larger – includes extended family members like grandparents, uncles, aunts, or other relatives.
Independence	Highly independent; decision-making and finances are usually self-contained.	More interdependent; often relies on extended family for support and decision-making.
Common in	Urban, industrialized, and modern societies.	Rural, traditional, or culturally diverse societies.
Examples	A couple (John and Mary) with their two children.	Single-parent families, blended families (step-parents/siblings), multi-generational households (grandparents, aunts/uncles)

Understanding family structures helps social workers:

- Assess the needs of individuals and families.
- Provide appropriate support and resources.
- Recognize the diversity of family dynamics in society.
- Address challenges like poverty, abuse, or mental health issues within different family contexts.

Conclusion:

Understanding a person's family structure helps identify the support systems, challenges, and dynamics they experience. For example, someone in a nuclear family might rely heavily on their immediate family for emotional and financial support, while a person in a single-parent family may face unique stressors like limited resources or parental burnout. In an extended family, individuals might benefit from shared responsibilities but could also experience conflicts due to multiple generations living together. By knowing the family structure, social workers can tailor interventions, provide targeted resources, and address specific issues like isolation, financial strain, or caregiving burdens, ensuring more effective and empathetic support.

Islamic Perspective on Building Society

From an Islamic perspective, society should be built on principles that promote social justice, family values, community service, education, and health.

Social Justice:

Islam emphasizes fairness, equality, and the protection of rights for all individuals, regardless of their social status, race, or gender. The Quran and Hadith stress the importance of justice in all aspects of life, including wealth distribution, legal systems, and social welfare.

Family Values:

Family is the foundation of society. Respect for parents, care for children, strong marital relationships, and compassion for relatives are heavily emphasized.

Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said: "The best of you is the one who is best to his family."

Community Service:

Islam encourages Muslims to serve their communities and help those in need. Acts of charity, volunteering, and supporting vulnerable members of society are highly rewarded. The concept of Ummah (global Muslim community) emphasizes collective responsibility and solidarity.

Education:

Seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim (male and female).

Both religious and worldly education are encouraged.

Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said: “The ink of a scholar is more sacred than the blood of a martyr.”

Health & Well-being:

Islam promotes cleanliness, hygiene, balanced diet, and physical exercise.

Prophet (PBUH) said: “There are two blessings which many people waste: health and free time.” (Bukhari)

Public health services are considered a duty of the state.

Interesting Note:

Both Karl Marx (Founder of Communism and author of The Communist Manifesto (1848) and Das Kapital.) and Hazrat Umar (RA) shared a deep concern for economic justice, but their methods and philosophies were completely different. Marx removed faith from the equation and relied on revolution. Hazrat Umar (RA) combined faith, ethics, and governance to create a balanced welfare society.

Social Policies:

Social policies are the plans, actions, and guidelines made by a government to improve the well-being of people in society. These policies focus on areas like health, education, housing, employment, poverty reduction, social justice, and welfare.

Purpose of Social Policies

- ✓ To reduce inequality between rich and poor
 - ✓ To protect vulnerable groups (orphans, widows, elderly, disabled)
 - ✓ To promote social justice (everyone gets basic rights)
 - ✓ To improve quality of life for all citizens
 - ✓ To ensure a fair and balanced society
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Social Evils: Social evils are the wrong actions, harmful practices, and negative habits that damage society as a whole. These evils break social order, destroy justice, and harm individuals or communities.

1. **Corruption** is not only committed by the government but also by every person who is not honest and keeps blaming others. If you do not give your 100% at work or in your relationships, you are also contributing to corruption.
2. **Bribery** — both the giver and the taker belong to hell.
3. **Hoarding** — selling things at higher prices when there is a need is unethical.
4. The **Wadera system** promotes injustice and inequality.
5. **Wasteful spending**, especially at weddings, is a social evil.

6. **Spreading rumors** is not a joke — gossiping can destroy lives.
7. Showing **little regard for the law** — for example, bikers not staying in their lanes — contributes to disorder.
8. The **caste system** divides society and promotes discrimination.
9. **Child labor** deprives children of their childhood and education.
10. The **excessive love for imported items**, like cosmetics, damages local industries.
11. **Getting admissions below merit** is unfair and discourages hardworking students.
12. **Spilling trash on the ground** pollutes the environment.
13. **Washing cars outside the house** can lead to fines — in Bahria, there's a fine of Rs. 10,000 for washing cars or hanging clothes outside homes.
14. **Strikes and holidays for no valid reason** disrupt the economy and education.
15. **Dowry** is a harmful social evil that creates unnecessary burdens.
16. **Illiteracy** is a root cause of many social problems.
17. **Ignorance** — it is important to gain good knowledge about social life and global issues instead of just focusing on your own domain.
18. **Superstitions** hold society back from progress.
19. **Racism** divides people and promotes hatred.
20. A **high rate of dependency** weakens society's ability to progress.
21. **Conspicuous consumption**, showing off wealth as a status symbol, is unnecessary and harmful.
22. **Being absent from duty** — for example, doctors skipping lectures — can have serious consequences and may even cost lives.
23. **Encroachments on roads**, such as taking extra space to build homes or ramps in front of gates, is illegal if it's outside your marked area.
24. **Gambling** ruins lives and families.

25. A bank has nothing to do with **customer service** if the customer themselves are careless — do not share your PIN or sensitive information with anyone.
26. **Depriving women of their inheritance** is against justice and religion.
27. **Un-Islamic rituals**, such as slapping women or depriving them of their basic rights, are completely unacceptable.
28. Creating **noise pollution** — even in class — is disrespectful and disturbing.
29. **Making corrupt people respectable** — such as glorifying corrupt prime ministers and chief ministers — encourages further corruption.
30. The joint family system, when forced, can create **unnecessary conflicts and stress**.
31. **Laziness** slows down personal growth and national progress.
32. **Blocking public pathways** to construct buildings is unfair and illegal.
33. Disturbing the whole neighborhood with **loud recitation in mosques** — even if you are reading the Quran — is inconsiderate.
34. **Playing music at high volume** to disturb neighbors is a social evil.
35. **Eating junk food** excessively increases health problems, which ultimately burdens the economy.
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LECTURE # 03

Education & Health

Services provided by the government or organizations to improve education and health in society.

Education System

It is divided into different levels:

- Primary: Early education (grades 1-5)
- Secondary: Middle and high school (grades 6-12)
- Bachelors: Undergraduate university degree.
- Masters: Postgraduate university degree.

Types of Learning

- Urdu Medium: Education taught in Urdu.
- English Medium: Education taught in English.

Private & Public Institutions

- Private Institutions: Privately owned schools, often expensive.
- Public Institutions: Government schools, often low-cost.

Key Fact:

- 60 million students exist.
- 30 million are out of school.
- 30 million are in school.

Issues of Lack of Education

Some problems caused by lack of education:

- **Capacity Shortage:** Schools cannot handle the large population.
- **Economic Issues:** Poverty, inflation, and unemployment make education harder to access.
- **Poor Teaching Quality:** Teachers are not trained well.
- **Different Education Systems:** Urdu vs English systems cause inequality.
- **Gender Inequality:** Girls often have fewer educational opportunities.
- **Low Standard of Education:** Curriculum and teaching methods are outdated.
- **Lack of Social Awareness:** Society doesn't prioritize education enough.
- **Poor Management:** Weak governance, corruption, and mismanagement in education departments.

Trust Schools

These are schools that run with the help of *charity*. They are often funded by donations from people, organizations, or trusts. Their goal is to provide education, especially to students who cannot afford expensive private education.

Policies at School Level

These are rules and plans made at the school level to manage education. Policies could include curriculum design, teacher training, student behavior rules, and how to handle exams.

Health Sector

The health sector consists of:

- **Public Health Services:** Provided by the government, usually low-cost or free.
- **Private Health Services:** Provided by private hospitals/clinics, usually expensive.
- **District Health Services:** Local government health services in districts.

Health Issues

Some major health problems in society include:

- **Lower Life Expectancy:** People living shorter lives due to poor healthcare.
- **Poor Maternal Health:** Mothers face complications during pregnancy and childbirth.
- **Infant Mortality:** Many babies die at birth or in early years due to poor medical care.

- **Insufficient Medical Facilities:** Not enough hospitals, doctors, and equipment.
 - **Diseases:** Increase in diseases like Hepatitis and Cancer.
 - **Food Deficiency:** Malnutrition due to lack of healthy food.
 - **Drug Abuse:** Many people suffer due to addiction to drugs.
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LECTURE # 04

POVERTY

Poverty means not having enough money or resources to meet basic needs like food, water, shelter, education, and healthcare. It's a major social issue in most developing countries.

Reasons:

- **Poor Resources:** Countries don't have enough natural or man-made resources.
- **Low Production:** Because of fewer resources, they produce less.
- **Less Earning:** Less production leads to fewer jobs and lower incomes.
- **Low Per Capita Income:** This is the average income per person. Formula:
$$\text{Per Capita Income} = \text{Total National Income} \div \text{Total Population}$$

How to measure poverty?

There are different ways:

Basic Needs Approach (Absolute Poverty)

Checks if people have food, shelter, clothes, education, healthcare (basic survival needs).

Caloric Approach

Focuses on how much food (in calories) people get daily. The minimum is:

2500 calories for males

1500 calories for females

Types of Poverty

- **Absolute Poverty** - People who cannot meet basic needs at all.
- **Relative Poverty** - People who are poorer compared to others in the same society (but they may still have basic needs covered).

INEQUALITY & STANDARD OF LIVING

Inequality isn't just about money. It's about differences in:

- Living conditions (houses, food, facilities)
- Thinking and education levels
- Health facilities
- Opportunities in life

Causes of Inequality

- **Income Inequality:** Some earn a lot, others very little.

- Resource Inequality: Unequal access to land, water, education, etc.
- Gender Inequality: Women and men don't have the same opportunities.
- Basic Needs Inequality: Some people get better food, health, and education than others.

Social Services

One important way to reduce inequality is through charity, like:

Zakat (a compulsory charity in Islam), which helps the poor directly.

Standard of Living

This means how well people live in terms of comfort, wealth, and basic facilities.

It's not only about money, but also education, health, safety, and even happiness.

Link Between Poverty & Inequality

This is the overall flow: Poverty -> Inequalities -> Charity -> Teamwork -> Ethics
